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EXPERIMENT 12
Approval Process in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To create and implement approval processes in Zoho Creator that route records to approvers for review, and to understand how approvals control decisions in a Loan Application, using the Loan Application Approval and EMI Payment Approval as examples.

2. Introduction

An Approval Process in Zoho Creator is a workflow that sends a submitted record to one or more approvers, who can approve or reject it before it is accepted. It is used where a decision by an authorised person is needed, such as approving a loan, a payment or a leave request. Approvals make business decisions formal, traceable and consistent, and they remove the need to follow up manually with managers.

An approval is created on a form in the Workflow section under the **Approvals** tab. For each approval the designer sets **who the approvers are**, **when** the approval starts, and the **actions** to be performed, for example updating the record status or sending a notification when a record is approved or rejected. In this experiment the approvals **Loan Application Approval** and **EMI_Payment_Approval** are created for the Loan Application.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To learn the meaning and importance of approval processes in Zoho Creator.
- To understand approvers, the approval trigger and the actions that follow a decision.
- To study how an approval is created on a form and enabled.
- To create working approvals for loan applications and EMI payments.
- To understand how approvals are listed and managed in the Workflow section.

4. Procedure

1 Sign in to Zoho Creator and open the **Loan Application**.

2 Click **Workflow** in the top menu and open the **Approvals** tab.

3 Click **New Workflow** and select the **Loan_Application_Form**.

4 Name the approval **Loan Application Approval** and choose when it should start (for example, **On review**).

5 Select the approver, such as a branch manager or a user role.

6 Add the actions to be carried out on the decision, such as updating **Approval_Status** to Approved or Rejected and sending a notification, so that the approval shows **5 Actions**.

7 Repeat steps 3 to 6 for the **EMI Payment Tracking Form** and name the approval **EMI_Payment_Approval**.

8 Save both approvals and make sure the status of each is **Enabled**.

9 Open the application in Access mode, submit a loan application and an EMI record, and check that they go for approval and the actions run after the decision.

10 Make necessary changes if required and publish the application.

5. Illustrative Example

Consider a Loan Management System developed using Zoho Creator, where loan applications, disbursements and EMI payments are maintained in forms. A loan application should be accepted only after an authorised person has reviewed it, and EMI payment records should also be reviewed before they are accepted.

5.1 Implementation using Zoho Creator

Two approvals are created in the Approvals tab. **Loan Application Approval** is attached to the **Loan_Application_Form**, and **EMI_Payment_Approval** is attached to the **EMI Payment Tracking Form**. Each approval has 5 actions, starts on review, is enabled and was created on 30-Oct-2026.

S.No	Approval Name	Form	Details	When	Status	Created On
1	Loan Application Approval	Loan_Application_Form	5 Actions	On review	Enabled	30-Oct-2026
2	EMI_Payment_Approval	EMI Payment Tracking Form	5 Actions	On review	Enabled	30-Oct-2026

The main parts of an approval and their use in the loan process are:

S.No	Approval Part	Use in the Loan Application
1	Form	The form whose records need approval, e.g., Loan_Application_Form.
2	Approver	The person or role who reviews and decides, e.g., a branch manager.
3	When (trigger)	Defines when the approval starts; here it is set to On review.
4	Actions	Steps run after the decision, e.g., updating Approval_Status or sending a notification.
5	Status	Enabled or disabled; only enabled approvals take effect.

5.2 Illustrative Approval Design

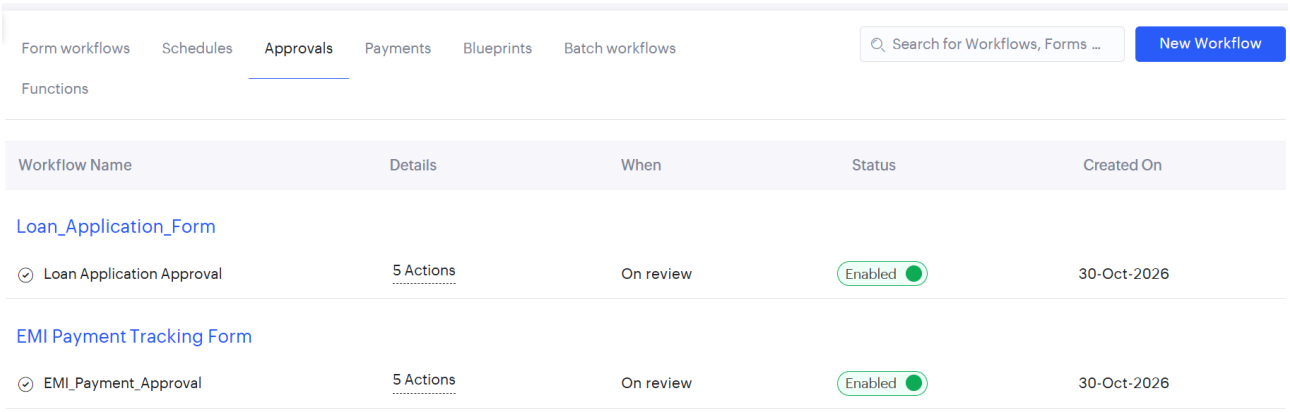


Figure 1: Approvals tab showing the two approvals

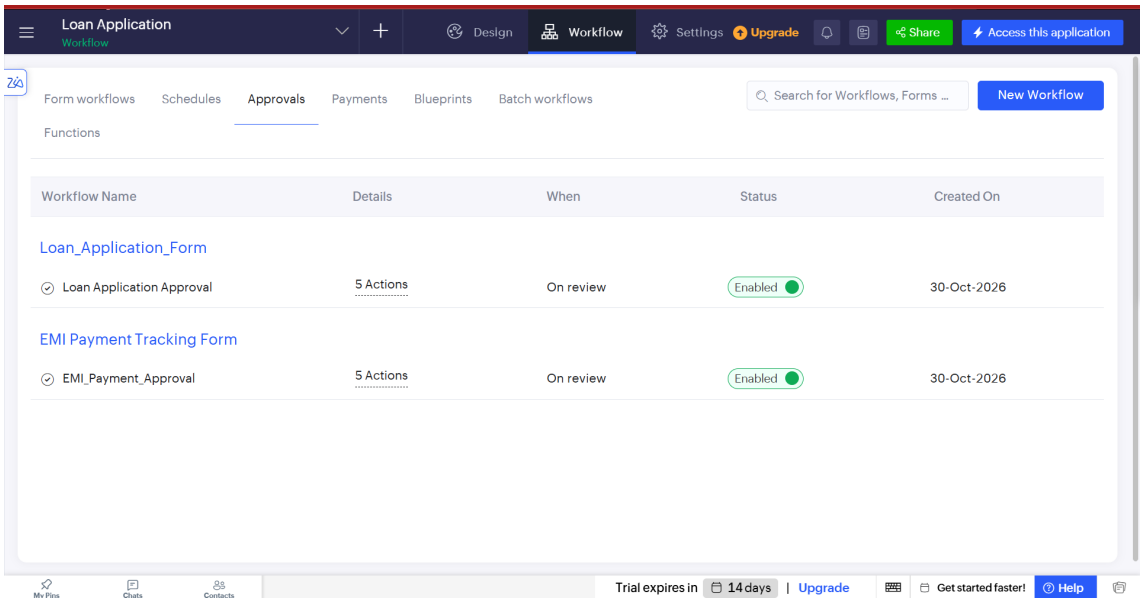


Figure 2: Approvals section of the Loan Application (complete view)

6. Advantages and Limitations

6.1 Advantages

- Makes sure important records are reviewed by an authorised person before acceptance.
- Keeps a clear record of who approved or rejected each request.
- Automatically runs follow-up actions after a decision.
- Reduces manual follow-up and speeds up decision making.
- Built with a simple configuration and little or no coding.

6.2 Limitations

- Processing stops until the approver acts, which can delay the process.
- Complex multi-level approvals may need careful design or Deluge scripting.
- Approvers must be set up correctly as users or roles in the application.
- Too many approvals on one form can make the process hard to manage.
- Available approval features depend on the capabilities of the Zoho Creator platform.

7. Result

The experiment was successfully completed by learning the process of creating approvals in Zoho Creator and implementing the Loan Application Approval and EMI_Payment_Approval for a Loan Application. The implementation showed how records can be sent for review and how actions can run automatically after a decision with minimal coding.